A WORKING SESSION FOR SELLERS

AI for Sales Professionals

What it's good at today, what it isn't, and the five things to do this week.

Mark R. Hinkle · CEO, Peripety Labs · Publisher, The AIE Network

THE ONE RULE

The AI drafts. You send.

Everything today hangs off that sentence. Research, email, call prep, follow-up, proposals. The assistant does the reading and the first draft. Your name goes on it, so you read it and you hit send.

WHERE AI FITS

What it's good at today, and what it isn't

GOOD AT

Reading and summarizing

A 10-K, forty job postings, a two-hour transcript. Faster than you, and it doesn't get tired. It does miss things, which is why the sources matter.

GOOD AT

First drafts and rehearsal

Email, follow-ups, proposals, and playing the skeptical buyer so you can practice.

NOT YET

Knowing your buyer

It has never met them. It doesn't know what was said at the last QBR unless you tell it.

NOT YET

Judgment and relationships

When to push, when to walk, who actually signs. That's still you, and it's the paid part.

WHERE AI FITS

Your week, with an assistant in the chair next to you

Research	**Account brief before the first call**	One prompt, a company name, ten minutes. Sources attached.
Prospect	**Who to call, and why now**	Rank a list against your ICP file and surface the trigger events.
Reach out	**First touch that sounds like you**	Under ninety words, one ask, written in your voice from your examples.
Meet	**Prep sheet, then listen**	Five questions and the likely objections. Recorder on so you can stop typing.
Follow up	**Summary and next steps in ten minutes**	From the transcript: email, CRM notes, tasks.
Propose	**First draft from your template and the call**	You check the numbers. It writes the words around them.

01

Research an account in ten minutes

The brief you'd want before any first call, with links, from a company name.

RESEARCH

Collect, brief, verify, then one sentence on why now

01

Collect

Their site, latest news, open job postings, the annual report if public, and the LinkedIn pages for your two or three contacts.

02

Brief

One prompt, with your ICP and product files loaded, produces the page.

03

Verify

Every claim gets a link. No link, no claim. Fix the two things it got wrong.

04

Why now

One line you could say out loud: the trigger, the likely pain, your angle.

RESEARCH · THE PROMPT

The account brief prompt

PROMPT · COPY THIS

```
Build a one-page account brief on [Company]. Use my ICP and product files.
Sources attached: [paste or link site, news, job posts, filings, contact profiles].

Sections: what they do and how they make money; what changed in the last six months;
what they're hiring for and what that says; who my contacts are and what they care about;
where Linkerd plausibly fits, in their words; three discovery questions; one "why now" sentence.
Cite a source for every factual claim. If you can't source it, mark it UNVERIFIED.
```

YOUR FIRST WEEK

Five days, one habit each

Day 1	**Build the three files**	Voice, ICP, product. Twenty minutes. Save them where your assistant loads them automatically.
Day 2	**Brief three accounts**	Ten minutes each. Click the links. Write the "why now" sentence for each.
Day 3	**Rewrite one sequence**	Three emails, under ninety words each, in your voice. Approve the first send yourself.
Day 4	**Record one call**	Prep sheet before, recorder on, follow-up and CRM notes sent inside ten minutes.
Day 5	**Review your toughest deal**	Run the skeptic prompt. Take the one action it names.